Mustafa Shikora

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Experience

Senior Software Engineer, Tech Lead, Discord – Remote Apr 2024 – present

Tech lead for the subscriptions platform team and point of contact for mobile revenue platform projects.

- Led the regional storefront project from design to full rollout, working with product, design, marketing, and data science; every user now has one set country that decides their catalog, currency, and prices. Built a dark launch to test it first, which other teams now reuse
- Led engineering response to a major App Store fraud incident: found the exploit, patched it in 2 days, and revoked the fraudulent subscriptions; also saved tens of thousands of subscriptions with Apple billing retry handling
- Tech lead for moving mobile purchases to a server-side order system; added pricing in two new local currencies so a retail gift card launch shipped on time, and led a legally required currency change in one country by its deadline
- Trusted subject matter expert for App Store and Google Play billing, consulted by other teams on design and launches; set technical direction after a multi-day Android purchase outage by writing the RFC and moving app store price syncing to a self-healing design
- Mentored 3 engineers who each took ownership of a major area (app store billing, regional pricing and mobile orders, console partner integrations)

Software Engineer, Discord – Remote May 2022 – Apr 2024

- Reduced involuntary churn by extending the mobile subscription grace period (about 40% on iOS, roughly half on Google Play)
- Led the first targeted discount launch, which became the base of the discounts platform; later built an API so another team could launch discounts without billing changes
- Led reliability for Google Play subscriptions: fixed tens of thousands of stuck subscriptions and added a recurring cleanup job
- Led the Android launch of the digital collectibles shop and built iOS subscription support for a creator monetization product
- Cut main API logging costs by about half, recovered tens of thousands of failed renewals using existing gift credit, and halved engineer time on support tickets

Senior Software Engineer, Venmo – Chicago, IL Mar 2020 – Apr 2022

- Backend lead for Credit Card Referrals program, processing thousands of referrals
- Feature lead for an automated process to reissue expiring debit cards for users, currently processing 300k+ debit cards per month
- Launched Cash-a-Check for direct deposit stimulus checks on Venmo
- Helped launch Venmo Credit Card; built repayments, autopay, and operational dashboards
- Fixed and improved Venmo CircuitBreaker to PayPal, strengthening HTTP call failure handling
- Subject Matter Expert for AWS on my team, consistently consult for new projects in the space

Software Development Engineer, Amazon – Seattle, WA Mar 2017 – Nov 2019

- Research, design, and implement highly scalable and available applications for vending catalog data to the supported devices for Prime Video
- Built and maintained data pipelines to export Prime Video data to third party clients
- Helping create a new process to recommend UX Language for the Amazon Video platform
- Researching, designing, and implementing 2 services with multiple APIs to select the preferred language for a customer and a device

Skills

Languages: Python, Java, Kotlin, Swift, TypeScript

Frameworks and Tools: Flask, SQLAlchemy, React.js, React Native, iOS, Git, Datadog, Sentry

Infrastructure and Data: Postgres, BigQuery, Pub/Sub, Terraform, Google Cloud Platform, AWS

Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Bachelor's in Applied Mathematics Aug 2013 – Dec 2016